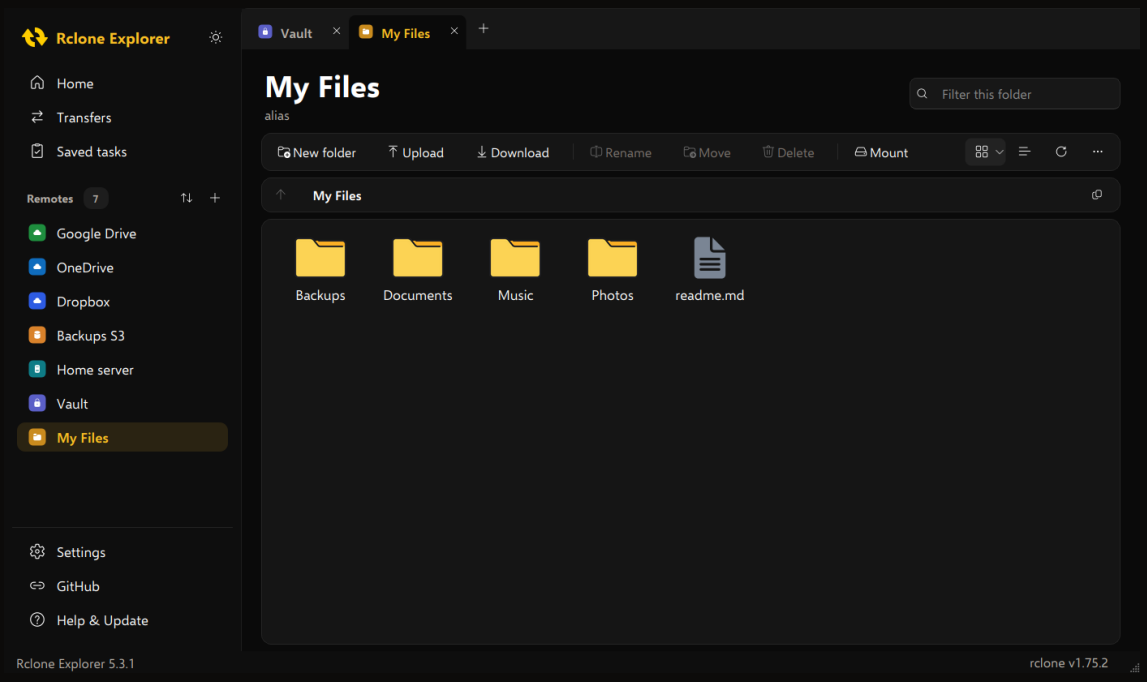
Rclone Explorer

User Guide - Version 5.3.1

The rclone GUI for Windows and Linux: browse, transfer and sync all your cloud storage



Rclone Explorer in dark mode: tabs, command bar, breadcrumb and the Icons view.

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CHAPTER 1

Getting started

Rclone Explorer is a portable rclone GUI for Windows and Linux. rclone is the command line tool that connects to more than 70 cloud storage services; Rclone Explorer gives it a full graphical interface. It needs no installation and does not change anything on your PC outside its own folder.

Requirements

- Windows 10 (version 1809 or newer) or Windows 11, 64-bit; or a 64-bit Linux distribution from 2022 or newer, for example Ubuntu 22.04, Debian 12 or Fedora 35 and later.
- About 150 MB of disk space for the app and the bundled rclone.
- Optional: WinFsp (winfsp.dev) on Windows or FUSE 3 on Linux to mount remotes as drives.
- Optional: a media player such as VLC or mpv for streaming.

Installing on Windows

- Download **RcloneExplorer-5.3.1-windows-x64.zip** from the Releases page of the GitHub repository.
- Optionally verify the download: the release also contains SHA256SUMS.txt. In PowerShell run `Get-FileHash .\RcloneExplorer-5.3.1-windows-x64.zip` and compare the value.
- Right-click the zip, choose **Extract All**, and pick any folder: Documents, D:\Tools or a USB stick all work.
- Run **Rclone Explorer.exe**. Because the app is not code-signed, Windows may show **Windows protected your PC**: click **More info**, then **Run anyway**. This is needed only once.

Installing on Linux

- Download **RcloneExplorer-5.3.1-x86_64.AppImage** from the Releases page.
- Make it executable: `chmod +x RcloneExplorer-*.AppImage`, or in your file manager **Properties > Allow executing as program**.
- Run it. If it does not start, install FUSE 2 (libfuse2t64 on Ubuntu 24.04 and newer, libfuse2 on older releases) or start it with `--appimage-extract-and-run`.
- To update later, download the new AppImage, or use AppImageUpdate, which fetches only the changed parts.
- Settings are stored in ~/.config/rclone-browser. For a portable setup, create a folder named like the AppImage plus .config next to it.

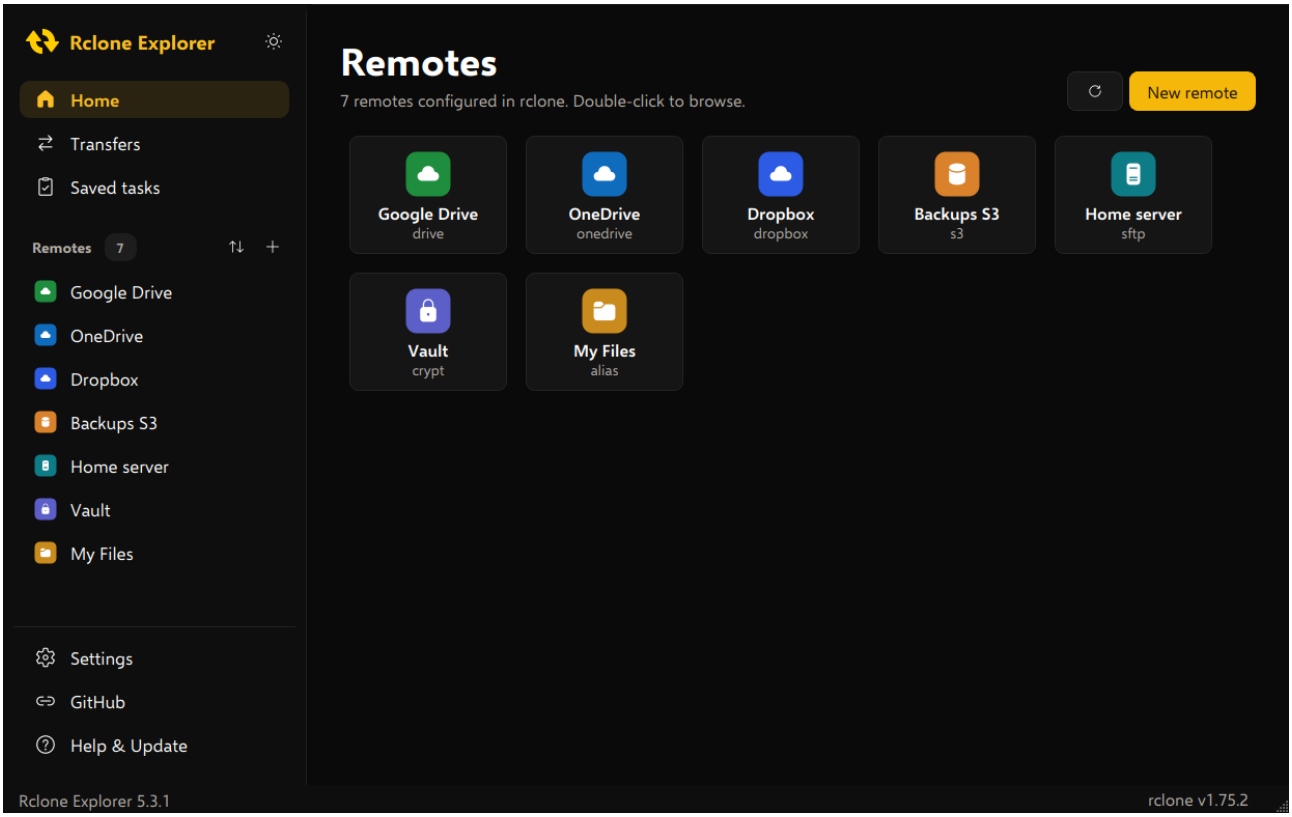
First start

Your existing rclone remotes appear automatically. If you have never used rclone, click **New remote** on the Home page (or the + next to Remotes in the sidebar). This opens rclone's setup assistant in a console window, which asks for the storage type and guides you through signing in. When it finishes, the new remote appears in the app.

> **Tip** If rclone itself is missing, the app offers to download the latest official version for you. The download is checksum-verified before it is used.

CHAPTER 2

The window at a glance



The Home page with remote cards (dark mode).

Area	What it does
Sidebar: Home	Overview of all remotes as cards. Double-click a card to browse it.
Sidebar: Transfers	Running and finished copies, syncs, mounts and streams. The gold number shows how many are running.
Sidebar: Saved tasks	Saved transfers that you can run again.
Sidebar: Remotes	Every configured remote with its service tile. Click to open it; right-click for **Open in new tab**, **Close all tabs** and **Reload remotes**. The number is the remote count, + adds a remote.
Sun / moon icon	Next to the app name: switches between light and dark.
Sidebar footer	**Settings**, **GitHub** (project page) and **Help & Update** (rclone updates, About, Quit).
Status bar	The app version on the left, followed by messages; the rclone version on the right. When an rclone update is available, the rclone version becomes a clickable link.

CHAPTER 3

Remotes

A remote is one storage location configured in rclone, for example your Google Drive, a OneDrive account, an S3 bucket or an SFTP server. Rclone Explorer reads them from rclone's configuration file.

Adding, editing and removing remotes

Click **New remote**. rclone's assistant opens in a console window and offers n (new remote), e (edit), d (delete), r (rename) and more. After closing it, the sidebar and Home page refresh automatically; use the refresh button on the Home page if not.

Service tiles

Each remote is shown with a logo or a colour-coded tile for its storage type, for example green for Google Drive, blue for OneDrive and teal for pCloud. You can replace any tile with your own picture; see Custom remote icons.

Sorting remotes

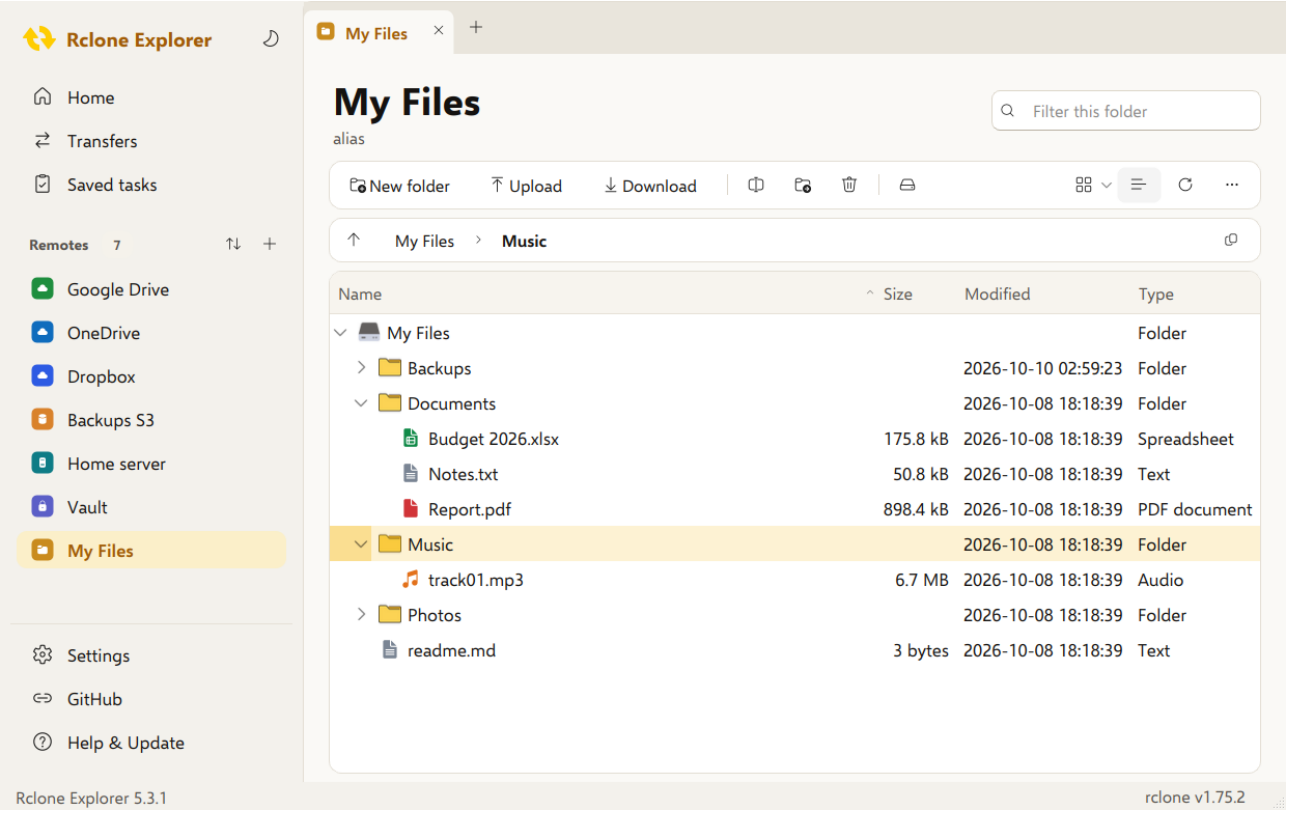
The sort button next to Remotes in the sidebar orders them by configuration order, name (A-Z or Z-A) or type. Choose **Custom** to drag them into your own order; it is remembered.

Encrypted configuration

If your rclone configuration is password-protected, the app asks for the password once per session. It is kept only in memory and passed to rclone through an environment variable, never on the command line and never written to disk.

CHAPTER 4

Browsing files



Details view in light mode with colour-coded file icons.

Tabs

- Clicking a remote in the sidebar opens it in a tab, or switches to it if already open.
- **Ctrl+T** or the + button opens the current remote in another tab, for example to compare two folders.
- The selected tab merges into the page, and + right after the last tab opens a new one.
- Close a tab with its X, **Ctrl+W**, or a middle-click. Tabs can be dragged to reorder them.

Icons and Details views

The two buttons at the right of the command bar switch the view. **Icons** (Ctrl+Shift+1) shows large icons; double-click a folder or press Enter to open it. The small arrow next to the Icons button chooses Extra large, Large, Medium or Small icons, and Ctrl + mouse wheel zooms between them. **Details** (Ctrl+Shift+2) shows a tree with size, modification date and type; click a column header to sort, right-click it to also show Extension and Path. The choice is remembered.

Command bar

When the window is narrow, the less used buttons and then all buttons show only their icons; hover over an icon to see its name. Google Drive remotes have **Show files shared with me** in the More (...) menu.

Address bar and filter

- The breadcrumb shows where you are; click any part to jump there. The Up arrow (Alt+Up) goes to the parent folder; the copy button copies the path in rclone notation (remote:path).
- **Filter this folder** (Ctrl+F) hides items whose names do not contain the text you type. Esc clears it.

File type icons

Folders are yellow; images teal; video purple; audio orange; archives brown; PDFs red; Word documents blue; spreadsheets green; presentations orange-red; code indigo; programs blue; everything else grey.

CHAPTER 5

Working with files

Select one or more items, then use the command bar, the right-click menu or a keyboard shortcut.

Command	Shortcut	What happens
New folder	F7	Creates a folder in the current folder.
Upload	Ctrl+U	Opens the transfer dialog to copy files from your PC. You can also drag files from your file manager onto the file list.
Download	Ctrl+D	Opens the transfer dialog to copy the selection to your PC.
Rename	F2	Renames the selected file or folder on the remote.
Move		Moves the selection to another folder on the same remote.
Delete	Del	Deletes the selection after confirmation. This cannot be undone.
Mount		Makes the folder available as a drive letter on Windows (needs WinFsp) or in a folder on Linux (needs FUSE 3).
More: Stream		Plays a media file in your player without downloading it first.
More: Folder size		Counts files and total size (runs on the remote).
More: Folder tree		Shows the folder structure as text.
More: Export file list		Saves a list of files as text or CSV.
More: Copy public link		Creates a sharing link where the service supports it.
Refresh	F5	Reloads the current folder.

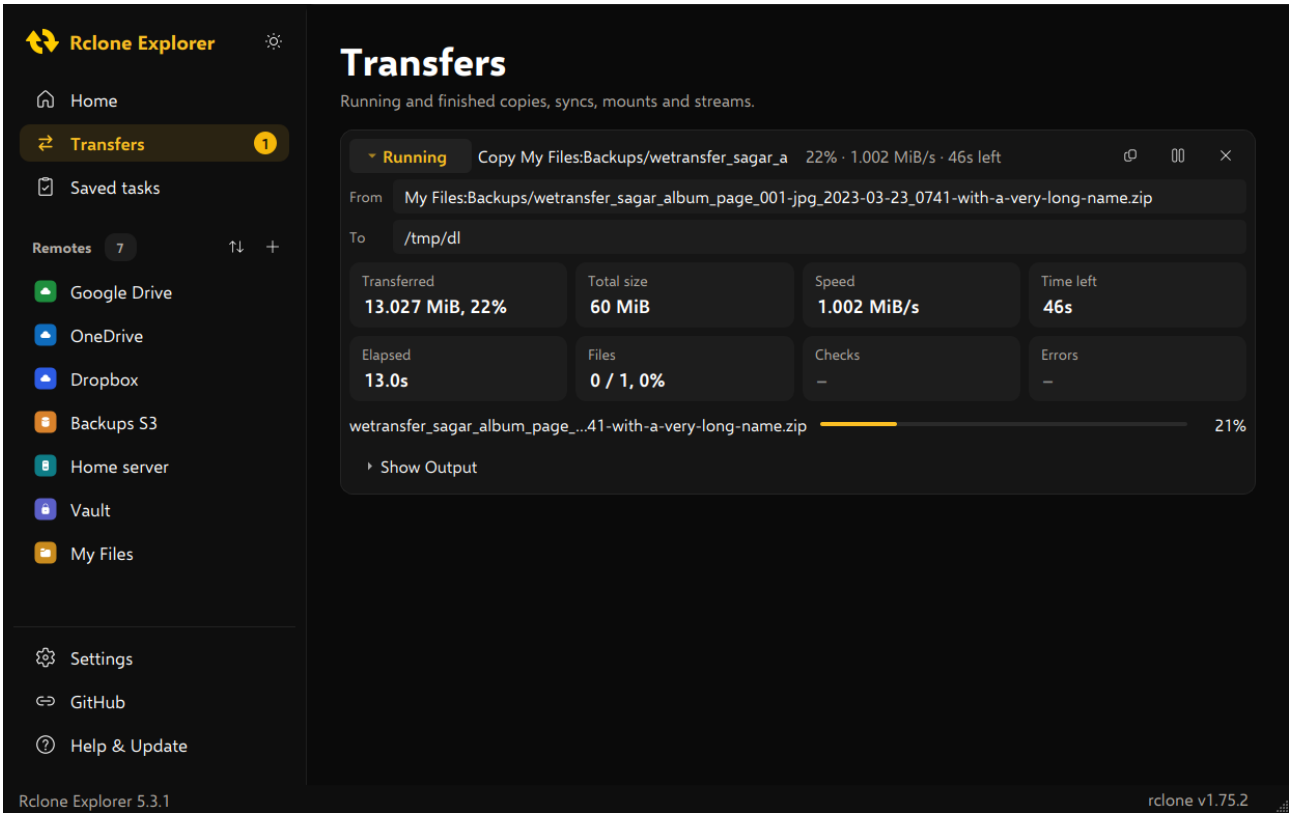
The transfer dialog

Upload, Download and Tasks share one dialog. **Mode** chooses Copy (keep source), Move (delete source afterwards) or Sync (make the destination identical, which can delete files there). **Skip files** and **Compare** control which files are transferred. The **Transfer** tab sets parallel transfers, bandwidth limits and timeouts; **Exclude** takes rclone filter patterns such as `*.tmp`. **Run** (Enter) starts the transfer, **Dry run** only shows what would happen, **Save task** stores the settings.

> **Important** Always try a Dry run before a Sync: sync deletes files on the destination that are not in the source.

CHAPTER 6

Transfers



A running transfer with statistics tiles and per-file progress.

- The coloured pill shows the state: Running (gold), Paused (grey), Finished (green) or Error (red). Click it to show or hide the details.
- The header line shows progress, speed and time left even when the card is collapsed.
- **Pause / Resume** (the pause and play buttons) freezes the rclone process and continues it later. Very long pauses can make some services drop the connection; rclone then retries automatically.
- The copy button copies the equivalent rclone command line, handy for scripts.
- The X button removes a finished transfer. On a running one it asks **Cancel this transfer?** first; **Keep running** or Esc leaves it alone.
- **Show Output** displays rclone's full log.
- The tiles show transferred and total size, speed, time left, elapsed time, files, checks and errors.

CHAPTER 7

Saved tasks

A task is a saved transfer: source, destination and all options. Use tasks for jobs you repeat, such as a weekly backup.

- Create one with **Save task** in the transfer dialog, and give it a description.
- On the Saved tasks page select a task, then use the buttons under the page title: **Run**, **Dry run**, **Edit** or **Delete**.
- **Sort by** at the top right shows the list in the order the tasks were saved, by name (A to Z or Z to A) or by type (downloads first). Names sort ignoring case and with numbers in natural order, so Task 2 comes before Task 10. The choice is remembered; it changes only how the list is shown.
- Tasks are stored in **tasks.bin**: in the app folder in portable mode, otherwise in the app's data folder (see Portable mode and where files are stored).

CHAPTER 8

Mounting and streaming

Mount a remote as a drive

Windows: install WinFsp from winfsp.dev, then select a folder and click **Mount**. The remote appears in File Explorer under a free drive letter. **Linux:** install FUSE 3 (package fuse3), click **Mount** and choose an empty folder as the mount point.

The mount is listed under Transfers. To unmount, click its X and confirm **Unmount**; programs still using it lose access to its files. Default options (for example `--vfs-cache-mode writes`) are set in Settings.

Stream media

Set **Stream command** in Settings, for example `"C:\Program Files\VideoLAN\VLC\vlc.exe" -` on Windows or `mpv -` on Linux, then use **More (...) > Stream** on a video or audio file. The stream is listed under Transfers; its X asks before stopping it.

CHAPTER 9

Settings and themes

Open **Settings** at the bottom of the sidebar. The sun / moon icon next to the app name switches between light and dark instantly.

Setting	Meaning
rclone location	Path to rclone. In portable mode on Windows: rclone/rclone.exe.
rclone.conf location	Path to rclone's configuration. Empty = rclone's default (%APPDATA%\rclone\rclone.conf on Windows, ~/.config/rclone/rclone.conf on Linux), or rclone\rclone.conf in the app folder if present.
Stream command	Player command line used by Stream.
Mount options	Extra rclone options for Mount.
Default download / upload folder	Folder pre-filled in the transfer dialog.
Default download / upload options	Extra rclone options for those transfers, e.g. `--bwlimit 5M`.
Default rclone options	Added to every rclone call, e.g. `--fast-list`.
Check for rclone updates	Daily check with an offer to install.
System tray	Always show the tray icon, close to tray, notify about finished transfers.
User interface	Theme (follow the system / Light / Dark), file and folder icons, alternating row colours, hidden files.
Proxy	Use the system's internet settings or a manual http/https proxy for rclone. Restart the app after changing.

CHAPTER 10

Portable mode and where files are stored

The Windows release is portable: the file **Rclone Explorer.ini** next to the exe switches portable mode on. Everything the app writes stays in its folder, and paths are stored relative to it, so the folder can be moved or copied to another PC.

What	Windows (portable)
rclone	rclone\rclone.exe
rclone configuration	%APPDATA%\rclone\rclone.conf by default; put a copy in rclone\rclone.conf to take your remotes with you
Settings	Rclone Explorer.ini
Saved tasks	tasks.bin
Custom remote icons	icons\remotes\
Documentation	docs\ (README, changelog, license, this guide)
Qt plugins	qt\plugins (found via qt.conf)

Security rclone.conf contains access tokens for your cloud accounts. If you carry it on a USB stick, protect it with rclone's own config encryption (run rclone config and choose s, then set a configuration password).

Non-portable use

On Windows, delete Rclone Explorer.ini to store settings in the registry (HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Software\rclone-browser) and tasks in %LOCALAPPDATA%\rclone-browser instead.

What	Linux
Settings	~/.config/rclone-browser/rclone-browser.conf
Saved tasks	~/.local/share/rclone-browser/rclone-browser/tasks.bin
Custom remote icons	~/.local/share/rclone-browser/rclone-browser/icons/remotes/

CHAPTER 11

Keeping rclone up to date

- Once a day the app checks downloads.rclone.org (GitHub as fallback) and offers **Update now**, **Skip this version** or **Later**.
- Check manually via **Help & Update > Check for rclone updates**; switch the daily check off in the same menu or in Settings.
- Downloads come only over HTTPS, are verified against rclone's published SHA-256 checksums, and the new rclone must run and report the expected version before it replaces the old one.
- Updating while transfers or mounts run is safe; they finish with the previous version.

CHAPTER 12

Custom remote icons

To use your own picture for a storage type, put a file named after the rclone type into the logo folder, then restart or right-click a remote and choose **Reload remotes**.

- **Windows:** icons\remotes next to Rclone Explorer.exe.
- **Linux:** ~/.local/share/rclone-browser/rclone-browser/icons/remotes/, or icons/remotes/ next to the AppImage in portable mode.
- Logos for 34 types are included: azureblob, b2, box, drime, drive, dropbox, fichier, filelu, filen, filescom, gcs, gofile, gphotos, hidrive, iclouddrive, internxt, jottacloud, koofr, mailru, mega, onedrive, opendrive, pcloud, pikpak, pixeldrain, premiumizeme, protondrive, putio, s3, seafile, storj, tardigrade, ulozto, zoho.
- Formats: **.png**, **.svg** or **.ico** (PNG wins if several exist). Square, ideally SVG or 256 x 256 px PNG with transparency.
- The icon applies to every remote of that type. The type is shown under each remote's name on the Home page.
- Most worth customising: cloud drives, photo services and object storage. Virtual types (alias, crypt, union and so on) wrap other remotes.

Cloud drive

File name	Service	Built-in tile	Colour
box.png	Box	cloud	#1A73C7
drime.png	Drime	cloud	#7C3AED
drive.png	Google Drive	cloud	#1E8E3E
dropbox.png	Dropbox	cloud	#2D5BE3
fichier.png	1Fichier	cloud	#E65A28
filefabric.png	Enterprise File Fabric	cloud	#4A5D7A
filelu.png	FileLu Cloud Storage	cloud	#2E7DD7
filen.png	Filen	cloud	#1F2937
filescom.png	Files.com	cloud	#2563EB
gofile.png	Gofile	cloud	#3B82F6
hidrive.png	HiDrive	cloud	#E2001A
huaweidrive.png	Huawei Drive	cloud	#CF0A2C
iclouddrive.png	iCloud Drive and Photos	cloud	#3A8EE6
internxt.png	Internxt Drive	cloud	#0066FF
jottacloud.png	Jottacloud	cloud	#6A4FB8
koofr.png	Koofr, Digi Storage	cloud	#2F9E6E
linkbox.png	Linkbox	cloud	#3BA7C9
mailru.png	Mail.ru Cloud	cloud	#1D6FD8

File name	Service	Built-in tile	Colour
mega.png	Mega	cloud	#D9272E
onedrive.png	Microsoft OneDrive	cloud	#0F6CBD
opendrive.png	OpenDrive	cloud	#3E82C4
pcloud.png	Pcloud	cloud	#139C9C
pikpak.png	PikPak	cloud	#3D7BE0
pixeldrain.png	Pixeldrain Filesystem	cloud	#4F8A3C
premiumizeme.png	premiumize.me	cloud	#E0632A
protondrive.png	Proton Drive	cloud	#6D4AFF
putio.png	Put.io	cloud	#E3A72A
quatrix.png	Quatrix by Maytech	cloud	#0E7490
seafile.png	seafile	cloud	#E06C16
shade.png	Shade FS	cloud	#525252
sharefile.png	Citrix Sharefile	cloud	#4C6A8E
sugarsync.png	Sugarsync	cloud	#0A84C6
ulozto.png	Uloz.to	cloud	#E5007E
yandex.png	Yandex Disk	cloud	#E0A100
zoho.png	Zoho	cloud	#C8312B

Photos & media

File name	Service	Built-in tile	Colour
cloudinary.png	Cloudinary	photos	#3448C5
gphotos.png	Google Photos	photos	#C2185B
imagekit.png	ImageKit.io	photos	#0450D5

Object storage

File name	Service	Built-in tile	Colour
azureblob.png	Microsoft Azure Blob Storage	bucket	#0F78D4
azurefiles.png	Microsoft Azure Files	bucket	#0F78D4
b2.png	Backblaze B2	bucket	#C8312B
gcs.png	Google Cloud Storage (this is not Google Drive)	bucket	#3367D6
netstorage.png	Akamai NetStorage	bucket	#0096D6
oos.png	Oracle Cloud Infrastructure Object Storage	bucket	#C74634
qingstor.png	QingCloud Object Storage	bucket	#2D8CF0

File name	Service	Built-in tile	Colour
s3.png	Amazon S3 and S3-compatible storage (AWS, Cloudflare R2, Wasabi, MinIO and more)	bucket	#D9822B
sia.png	Sia Decentralized Cloud	bucket	#1ED660
storj.png	Storj Decentralized Cloud Storage	bucket	#2683FF
swift.png	OpenStack Swift (Rackspace, OVH and more)	bucket	#B85C1E
tardigrade.png	Storj Decentralized Cloud Storage	bucket	#2683FF

Server / protocol

File name	Service	Built-in tile	Colour
ftp.png	FTP	server	#3B7E5B
hdfs.png	Hadoop distributed file system	server	#5E6B78
http.png	HTTP	globe	#4E6A92
sftp.png	SSH/SFTP	server	#0E7C86
smb.png	SMB / CIFS	server	#4E6A92
webdav.png	WebDAV	server	#7553C0

Archive

File name	Service	Built-in tile	Colour
doi.png	DOI datasets	archive	#555D66
internetarchive.png	Internet Archive	archive	#555D66

Local / virtual

File name	Service	Built-in tile	Colour
alias.png	Alias for an existing remote	folder	#C98B1E
archive.png	Read archives	folder	#C98B1E
cache.png	Cache a remote	folder	#C98B1E
chunker.png	Transparently chunk/split large files	folder	#C98B1E
combine.png	Combine several remotes into one	folder	#C98B1E
compress.png	Compress a remote	folder	#C98B1E
crypt.png	Encrypt/Decrypt a remote	lock	#5B5FC7
hasher.png	Better checksums for other remotes	folder	#C98B1E
local.png	Local Disk	drive	#5E6B78
memory.png	In memory object storage system.	drive	#5E6B78
union.png	Union merges the contents of several upstream fs	folder	#C98B1E

CHAPTER 13

Keyboard shortcuts

Shortcut	Action
Ctrl+T	Open the current remote in a new tab
Ctrl+W	Close the current tab
Ctrl+F	Filter the current folder (Esc clears)
Ctrl+Shift+1 / Ctrl+Shift+2	Icons view / Details view
Ctrl + mouse wheel	Bigger / smaller icons (Icons view)
Enter, double-click	Open folder (Icons view)
Alt+Up	Parent folder
F5	Refresh
F7	New folder
F2	Rename
Del	Delete
Ctrl+U / Ctrl+D	Upload / Download
Middle-click on a tab	Close it
Ctrl+Q	Quit (asks first if transfers, mounts or streams are running)

CHAPTER 14

Troubleshooting and FAQ

A remote shows an error or stays empty

Open Transfers or run the same remote in a console with `rclone lsd remote:` to see rclone's message. Expired sign-ins are renewed with `rclone config reconnect remote:`.

Mount does not work

On Windows install WinFsp; on Linux install FUSE 3 and choose an empty folder. Mount options are in Settings.

The AppImage does not start

Install FUSE 2 or run it with `--appimage-extract-and-run`. It needs a distribution from 2022 or newer (glibc 2.34).

Windows SmartScreen blocks the app

Click More info, then Run anyway. The release checksum lets you confirm that the file is the published one.

Large folders load slowly

Add `--fast-list` to Default rclone options for bucket-based storage (S3, B2, GCS). Some services are slow to list by nature.

Text looks too small or too large

The app follows the display scaling of Windows (Settings > System > Display > Scale) or of your Linux desktop.

CHAPTER 15

Security

- Credentials stay in rclone's configuration; the app never stores cloud passwords or tokens itself.
- The rclone configuration password lives only in memory and is passed via an environment variable, not on the command line.
- rclone updates: HTTPS only, SHA-256 verified, size-limited, and tested before installation.
- Folder listings use rclone's JSON output, which handles any file name safely (spaces, quotes, unusual characters).
- No shell is involved when starting rclone or a media player: arguments are passed directly, so file names cannot inject commands.
- The Windows build uses Control Flow Guard, CET shadow-stack compatibility, ASLR and DEP to make memory-corruption exploits much harder.
- Release builds are produced on GitHub's servers from the public source, with every build action pinned to an exact commit, and each release lists the SHA-256 of the zip and the AppImage.

CHAPTER 16

For developers

Path	Contents
src/	C++20 / Qt 6 source. main_window_shell.cpp builds the sidebar and pages; remote_widget.cpp the browser; theme.cpp the colours, icons and style sheet.
src/icons/fluent/	Fluent UI System Icons (MIT). Every SVG here is compiled in automatically as :/fluent/<name>.svg.
tests/	Unit tests for rclone output parsing, settings migration and natural sorting (ctest).
docs/	Screenshots (docs/guide/take_screenshots.sh), remote-icons.md and this guide (docs/guide/build_guide.py).
packaging/linux/	Desktop file, icon and AppStream metadata for the AppImage.
.github/workflows/	Windows and Linux builds, packaging, releases and the website.

Building

- Windows: Visual Studio 2022 or newer with C++ desktop tools, CMake 3.21+, Ninja, Qt 6.10+ (MSVC 64-bit, with Qt SVG).
- Linux: a C++20 compiler, CMake 3.21+, Ninja and Qt 6.10+ with Qt SVG.
- `cmake -S . -B build -G Ninja -DCMAKE_BUILD_TYPE=Release`
- `cmake --build build` and `ctest --test-dir build`

Releasing

Update VERSION and src/resources.rc, add a CHANGELOG entry, retake the screenshots and rebuild this guide, push main, then push a tag such as `v5.3.1`. GitHub Actions builds the zip and the AppImage and publishes the release.